

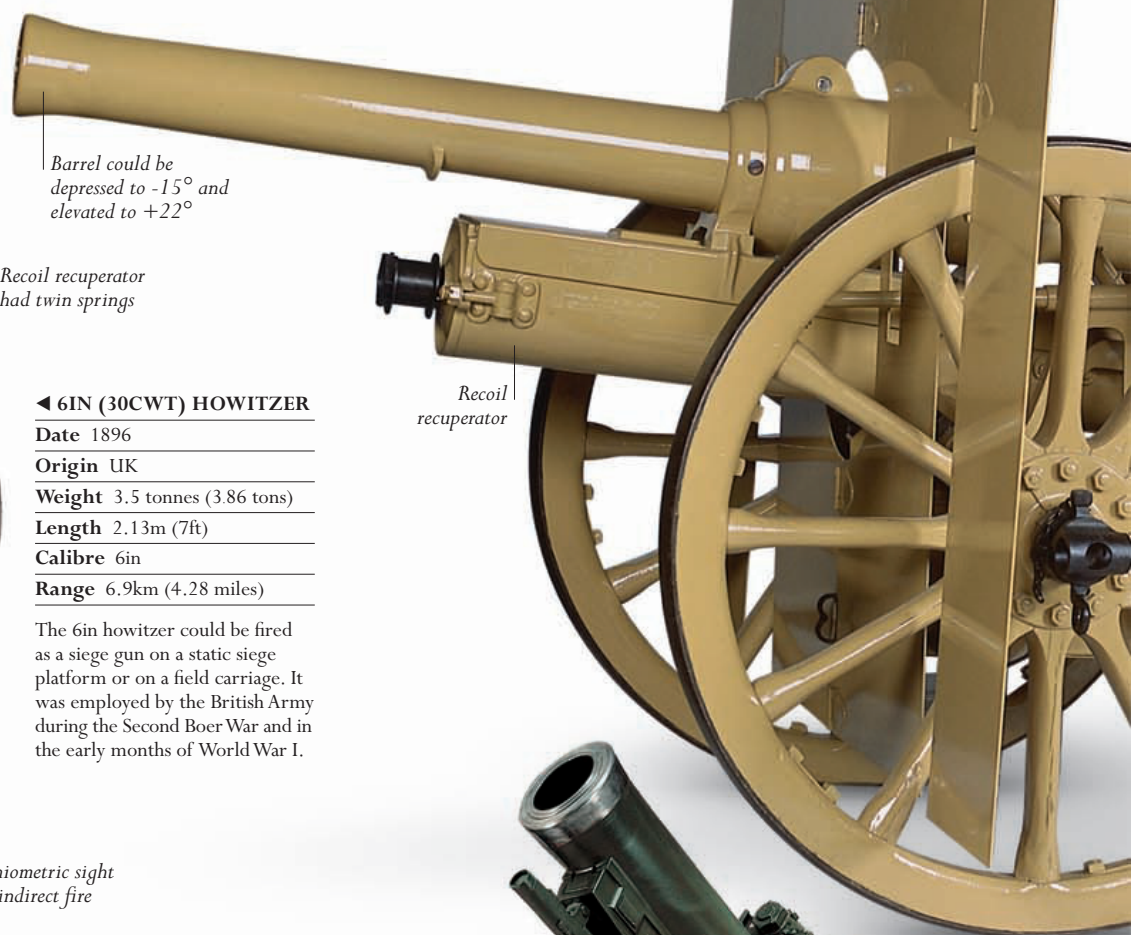
FIELD GUNS, SIEGE GUNS, AND HOWITZERS

The artillery pieces in use by 1914 were capable of inflicting casualties on an industrial scale. They ranged from mountain guns that could be broken down quickly and carried by mules, and light guns such as the 18-pounder quick-firer – which were used on the battlefield rather than fired from a dug-in position – to howitzers such as the British Army's 9.2in Mark I. The latter arrived in France early in 1915 and became the most effective counter-battery weapon of the war, capable of hurling a 130kg (290lb) high-explosive shell to a distance of more than 9km (5½ miles). Guns mounted on railway tracks that could reach a target more than 40km (25 miles) away were used for long-range bombardment.

▼ 2.75IN MOUNTAIN GUN

Date	1911
Origin	UK
Weight	585kg (1,290lb)
Length	1.84m (6ft)
Calibre	2.75in
Range	5.5km (3.41 miles)

This was an improved version of the tried-and-tested 10-pounder mountain gun. For transportation, the barrel broke down into two sections and the rest of the gun into a further three. It could be carried by six mules, or towed.



◀ 6IN (30CWT) HOWITZER

Date	1896
Origin	UK
Weight	3.5 tonnes (3.86 tons)
Length	2.13m (7ft)
Calibre	6in
Range	6.9km (4.28 miles)

The 6in howitzer could be fired as a siege gun on a static siege platform or on a field carriage. It was employed by the British Army during the Second Boer War and in the early months of World War I.

Recoil recuperator

Barrel elevated to 35° on wheeled carriage, 70° on siege platform

Elevation handwheel

Recoil recuperator had twin springs

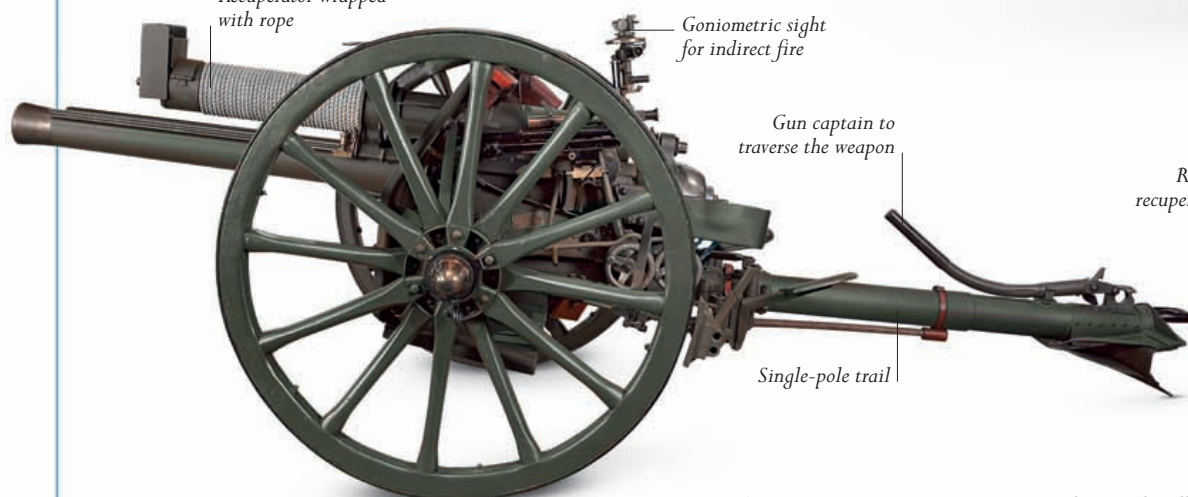
Wheels could be detached, and the gun fired from a built-in "siege platform"

Recuperator wrapped with rope

Goniometric sight for indirect fire

Gun captain to traverse the weapon

Single-pole trail



▲ 18-POUNDER QF MARK II

Date	1904
Origin	UK
Weight	1.28 tonnes (1.41 tons)
Length	2.34m (7¾ft)
Calibre	3.3in
Range	6km (3.72 miles)

The standard British field gun for almost four decades, the 18-pounder was first introduced in 1904. It fired a wide variety of projectiles, including high explosive, shrapnel, gas, and armour-piercing rounds. Its six-man crew could fire 20 rounds per minute for short periods.

▶ 9.2IN SIEGE HOWITZER MK I

Date	1914
Origin	UK
Weight	12 tonnes (13.2 tons)
Length	3.4m (11ft)
Calibre	9.2in
Range	9.2km (5.71 miles)

This was the Allies' most effective counter-battery weapon, destroying enemy artillery from concealed positions well behind the fighting front. More than 650 were employed on the Western Front by the British and US armies.

Recoil recuperator

